

Moss and the Broken Boat

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Moss was a tiny mouse.

He had a little wooden boat.

It was his favorite toy in the whole world.

Every day, he sailed it in the puddle by the oak tree.

One windy day, the boat bumped a rock.

CRACK!

The boat split in two.

Moss felt sad.

His heart felt heavy.

Tears filled his eyes.

"My boat," he whispered.

"It is broken."

Grandma Mouse came to sit with him.
She put her arm around him.



She said, "I see you feel sad."

Moss nodded.

"It is okay to feel sad," she said.

"It was your favorite boat."

Moss cried a little.

Grandma waited.

She did not rush him.

She just stayed close.

Then she said, "Sad feelings need soft time."

"Sad feelings need soft time," she said again,
stroking his ear.

"Sad feelings need soft time," she said one more
time.

Moss breathed slowly.

He felt a little lighter.

"What can we do?" he asked.



Grandma smiled.

"We can fix it together," she said.

They found some sticky pine sap.

They pressed the two halves together.

They tied a string around the middle.

The boat had a crack line now.

But it floated again.

Moss put it in the puddle.

It sailed in little circles.

Moss smiled his first smile of the day.

"Thank you, Grandma," he said.

That night, Moss put his boat by his bed.

The crack showed in the moonlight.



Moss did not mind anymore.

The boat was still his boat.

Moss snuggled under his leaf blanket.

Grandma sang a soft song.

Moss felt sad earlier.

Now he felt peaceful.

He closed his eyes.

He was loved.

He was cozy.

Goodnight, Moss.

Moral: *Sad feelings get softer when we share them and take our time.*

The End